

RACHEL KHOZA

Lead DevSecOps · Cloud Security Engineer · Automation Architect

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead DevSecOps and Cloud Security Engineer with 16+ years across global financial services (Absa, Capitec, Discovery, Barclays) and automotive (BMW), specialising in secure-by-default platforms on Azure and AWS. Proven record of embedding security into CI/CD, hardening multi-cloud landing zones, and enabling large engineering organisations to ship faster without compromising compliance (ISO 27001, PCI-DSS, SOC 2). Deep technical skillset across Terraform, Ansible, Kubernetes, Python and PowerShell, combined with a strategic view of cloud risk, supply chain security and developer experience. Available for senior remote roles globally.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Cloud & Platform Azure · AWS · Multi-Cloud Landing Zones · Well-Architected Framework · FinOps

Security & Compliance DevSecOps · SAST / DAST · IaC Security (Checkov, tfsec, Terrascan) · Container Security (Trivy, Aqua) · Supply Chain Security (SBOM, SLSA) · Secrets Management (HashiCorp Vault, Key Vault, Secrets Manager) · IAM & Zero Trust · OIDC Federation · ISO 27001 · PCI-DSS · SOC 2

Infrastructure as Code Terraform · Ansible (AAP) · Helm · Pulumi

CI / CD GitHub Actions · GitLab CI · Jenkins · Azure DevOps · ArgoCD

Containers & Orchestration Kubernetes (EKS, AKS) · Docker · Service Mesh (Istio)

Observability Azure Monitor · Grafana · Prometheus · Splunk · ELK · Dynatrace

Programming Python · PowerShell · Bash · SQL · JavaScript

Data Platform Databricks · Delta Lake · Azure Data Factory

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Shipped a secure-by-default CI/CD pipeline template (SAST + DAST + SBOM + IaC scanning) adopted by 25+ services, reducing critical production vulnerabilities by ~60% and cutting mean time to detect from ~14 days to <24h.
- Designed and rolled out a secure multi-cloud landing zone on Azure and AWS using Terraform with automated guardrails, onboarding 15+ engineering teams and cutting environment provisioning time from ~5 days to ~4 hours.
- Published reusable Ansible collections and Terraform modules used across 12+ business units at BMW, standardising patching, compliance scanning and cloud lifecycle management.
- Drove a container image hardening and CVE reduction programme, cutting critical / high CVEs by ~65% across 200+ container workloads.
- Built FinOps dashboards and automated remediation actions at Capitec, surfacing ~R4m in annual cost savings opportunities.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AnywhereNow

Oct 2025 – Present

Lead DevSecOps Engineer

- Own DevSecOps strategy across a multi-cloud estate; lead security-into-SDLC across 10+ engineering squads.
- Designed secure landing zones and policy-as-code guardrails (OPA / Checkov) for Azure and AWS using Terraform and Ansible.
- Built CI/CD pipeline templates integrating SAST, DAST, secret scanning, IaC testing, SBOM generation and compliance automation — ~60% reduction in security findings reaching production.
- Implemented container image hardening and CVE reduction pipelines, cutting critical CVEs by ~65% across 25+ services.
- Improved incident response via Azure Monitor + Grafana automation, reducing mean time to detect by ~50%.
- Partnered with engineering and analytics leadership to shape scalable, secure platform architectures.

BMW

Jul 2024 – Sep 2025

Lead Ansible & Cloud Engineer

- Lead engineer for Ansible Automation Platform (AAP) and multi-cloud infrastructure delivery supporting 15+ teams and 200+ workloads.
- Built reusable Ansible collections and Terraform modules that reduced new-service onboarding from ~5 days to ~4 hours.
- Orchestrated Azure and AWS provisioning through AAP with embedded security, identity and network baselines.
- Delivered automated patching, compliance scanning and lifecycle management tooling — ~70% fewer unpatched critical vulnerabilities month-over-month.
- Integrated Dynatrace observability with auto-remediation workflows in AAP, reducing manual ops toil by ~20 hours/week.

Discovery (Vitality Global)

Dec 2023 – Jun 2024

Senior DevSecOps Engineer

- Automated cloud security controls and shift-left security gates across Git workflows covering 80+ repositories.
- Integrated SAST, dependency scanning (Snyk / Dependabot) and secret validation (Gitleaks), reducing vulnerabilities merged to main by ~55%.
- Drove a vulnerability remediation programme, improving cloud compliance posture score by ~18 points.

Capitec Bank

Jul 2022 – Nov 2023

Cloud Security Engineer

- Automated deployments via GitHub Actions and Terraform across 60+ cloud workloads, enabling zero-downtime releases.
- Built FinOps dashboards and automated remediation actions — surfaced ~R4m in annual cost savings opportunities.
- Integrated cloud security scanning (Prisma Cloud / Defender for Cloud) and enforced governance through policy-as-code.

Absa Bank

Jan 2016 – Jun 2022

Cloud Security & DevOps Engineer

- Designed cloud security and automation pipelines across AWS and Azure for a regulated banking estate of 300+ workloads.
- Developed ML-based anomaly detection enhancements integrated into monitoring pipelines, improving alert signal-to-noise by ~40%.
- Built Terraform security patterns, Service Control Policies (SCPs) and IAM baselines reused across 12+ business units.
- Supported SQL workloads, transformation pipelines and engineering dashboards serving 500+ internal users.

Barclays Bank

2010 – 2015

SQL DBA & Developer

- Delivered SQL automation, performance tuning and monitoring dashboards supporting mission-critical banking workloads.

CERTIFICATIONS

Cloud AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional (2023) · Microsoft AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals (2024)

Security ISC² Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) (2023) · Cybersecurity: Managing Risk – Harvard (2021)

IaC & Data HashiCorp Terraform Associate (2022) · AWS Certified Machine Learning – Specialty (2021)

EDUCATION

BTech, Computer Systems Engineering · Tshwane University of Technology · 2004